

SS3 FASHION DESIGN & GARMENT MAKING LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: REVIEW OF SS1 & SS2 WORK

TOPIC: CORE CONCEPTS RECAP

Introduction

This week serves as a crucial foundation, revisiting the fundamental knowledge and skills acquired in SS1 and SS2. A strong grasp of these core concepts is essential for mastering the advanced topics in SS3, particularly as we move towards the business and entrepreneurial aspects of fashion design.

A. Review of SS1: The fundamentals

1. Introduction to fashion design

- **Fashion terminologies:** Recap of terms like *Haute Couture*, *Prêt-à-Porter* (Ready-to-Wear), *Style*, *Trend*, *Fad*, *Classic*, *Silhouette*, *Design*, etc.
- **Principles of design:**
 - Balance: Asymmetrical and Symmetrical.
 - Rhythm: Achieved through repetition, gradation, or radiation.
 - Emphasis: The focal point of a design.
 - Proportion: The relationship of parts to each other and to the whole.
 - Harmony/Unity: The pleasing arrangement of all parts.
- **Elements of design:**
 - Line: Vertical, Horizontal, Diagonal, Curved.
 - Shape/Silhouette: The garment's outline (e.g., A-line, Hourglass, Tubular).
 - Colour: Hue, Value, Intensity. Understanding the colour wheel.
 - Texture: The look and feel of fabric (e.g., smooth, rough, shiny).

2. Sewing tools and equipment

- **Measuring tools:** Tape measure, Ruler, Seam gauge.
- **Drafting tools:** Pattern paper, Pencils, Erasers, French curves, L-square.
- **Cutting tools:** Shears (for fabric), Scissors (for paper), Pinking shears, Seam ripper.
- **Stitching tools:** Hand needles, Sewing machine (Industrial and Domestic), Thimble.
- **Pressing tools:** Iron (Steam/Dry), Ironing board, Press cloth.

3. Basic stitches

- **Hand stitches:**
 - Temporary: Tacking/Basting (Even, Uneven, Diagonal).
 - Permanent: Backstitch, Running stitch, Hemming stitch, Buttonhole stitch.
 - Decorative: Chain stitch, Satin stitch, French knot.
- **Machine stitches:** Straight stitch, Zigzag stitch, Overlocking/Serging.

B. Review of SS2: Garment construction

1. Fabrics and textiles

- **Fibre classification:**
 - Natural: Plant-based (Cotton, Linen) and Animal-based (Wool, Silk).
 - Synthetic/Man-made: Polyester, Nylon, Rayon, Spandex.
- **Fabric construction:** Weaving (Plain, Twill, Satin weaves) and Knitting.
- **Fabric finishes:** Dyeing, Printing, Sanforizing (anti-shrinkage), Mercerizing (adds lustre).
- **Fabric identification:** Visual inspection, touch, and burn test.

2. Pattern drafting

- **Definition:** The process of creating a 2D template (pattern) for a 3D garment.
- **Methods:**
 - Flat pattern drafting: Using body measurements to create a *block* or *sloper* (a basic pattern) from scratch.
 - Drafting from a commercial pattern: Altering a pre-made pattern.

- **Key measurements:** Bust, Waist, Hips, Shoulder, Sleeve length, Trouser length, Crotch depth, etc.
- **Pattern markings:** Grainline, Notches, Darts, Seam allowance, Fold line.

3. Garment construction processes

- **Pre-construction:** Taking measurements, fabric selection, pattern drafting, fabric preparation (washing, ironing), and pattern layout/cutting.
- **Construction:**
 - Seams: Types (Plain, French, Flat-felled), finishes (Overlocking, Pinking).
 - Darts: Single-pointed, Double-pointed (for shaping).
 - Fullness: Gathers, Pleats (Knife, Box), Tucks.
 - Openings & Fasteners: Zippers (invisible, lapped), Buttons/Buttonholes, Snaps, Hooks & Eyes.
 - Facings & Collars: Shaped facings, Bias facings, Shirt collars, Peter Pan collars.
 - Sleeves: Set-in sleeves, Raglan sleeves, Kimono sleeves.
 - Pockets: Patch pockets, In-seam pockets.
 - Hemming: Topstitched, Blind hem, Rolled hem.

C. Conclusion

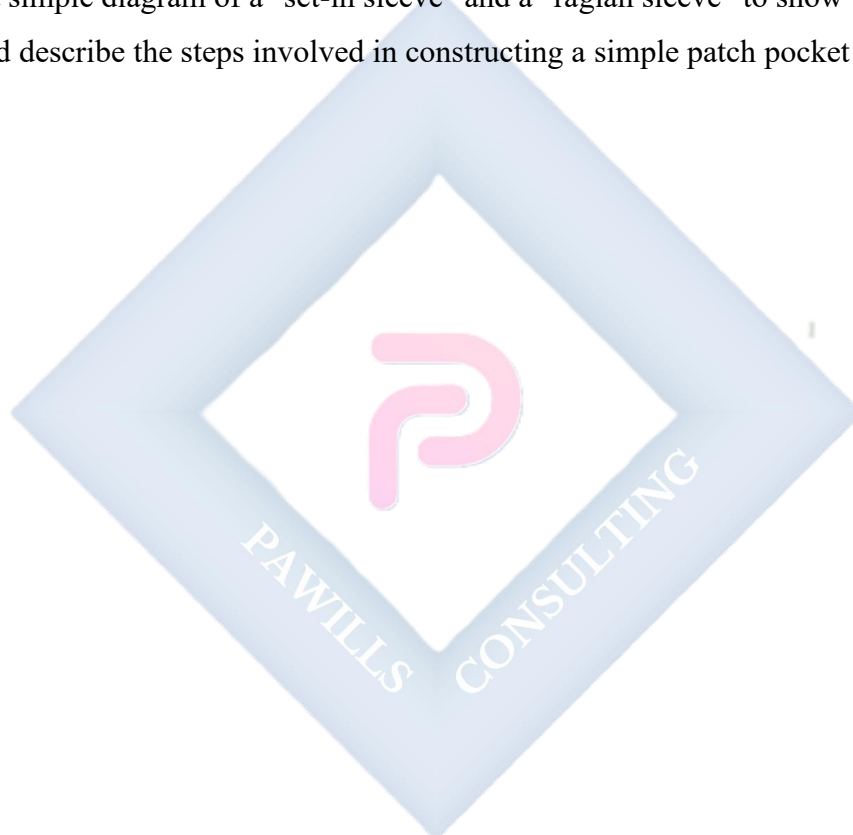
This review solidifies your understanding of the entire garment creation process, from the initial design idea to the finished product. This technical expertise is the platform upon which you will now build a successful business.

Evaluation questions

1. What is the difference between a "fad" and a "classic" style?
2. List the five principles of design.
3. Name one temporary hand stitch and two permanent hand stitches.
4. What is a "sloper" or "block" in pattern drafting?
5. What are pattern markings, and why are they important?

Assignment questions

1. Explain the difference between the "Elements of Design" and the "Principles of Design," giving two examples of each.
2. In a tabular format, list five measuring tools, five cutting tools, and five pressing tools, stating the specific function of each.
3. Describe the process of fabric identification using the "burn test" for Cotton, Wool, and Polyester. What are the expected results for each (flame, smell, ash)?
4. Draw a simple diagram of a "set-in sleeve" and a "raglan sleeve" to show the difference.
5. List and describe the steps involved in constructing a simple patch pocket on a garment.



WEEK 2: TAILORING BUSINESS I

TOPIC: SETTING UP A FASHION WORKSHOP

Introduction

Moving from a skilled artisan to a business owner requires a shift in mindset. A fashion workshop (or "atelier") is the operational heart of any tailoring or fashion design business. Setting one up correctly involves careful planning, strategic investment, and an understanding of business logistics.

A. Definition of a fashion workshop

A fashion workshop is the dedicated physical space where all production-related activities of a fashion business take place. This includes designing, pattern drafting, cutting, sewing, fitting, and finishing garments. It can range from a small home-based studio to a large-scale factory.

B. Key factors in setting up a workshop

1. Capital

- **Definition:** The money and assets needed to start the business.
- **Sources:** Personal savings, loans (family, bank, microfinance), grants, investors.
- **Uses:** Rent, purchase of machines, raw materials (fabrics, threads), utilities, salaries, registration.

2. Location

- **Visibility & accessibility:** Should it be visible to walk-in customers (e.g., a high street) or in a less expensive industrial area (if you only do production for other brands)?
- **Proximity to market:** Close to target customers and suppliers (fabric markets).
- **Infrastructure:** Access to reliable electricity (crucial for machines), water, and good roads.
- **Cost:** Rent and local taxes must be affordable and fit within the budget.

- **Space:** Must be large enough for all activities, including storage and a fitting area.

3. Legal requirements

- **Business registration:** Registering the business name with the Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC) in Nigeria (e.g., as a Business Name or Limited Liability Company).
- **Permits & licences:** Obtaining local government permits, signage permits, etc.
- **Tax registration:** Obtaining a Tax Identification Number (TIN).
- **Compliance:** Adhering to labour laws and safety regulations.

4. Essential equipment and tools

- **Industrial machines:** Straight stitch machine, Overlock/Serging machine, Buttonhole machine, Pressing iron (industrial steam iron is ideal).
- **Furniture:** Cutting table (large and waist-height), sewing machine tables, chairs/stools, storage (shelves, rails), full-length mirrors.
- **Tools:** Full sets of measuring, cutting, and drafting tools (as reviewed in Week 1).
- **Fittings:** Mannequins/Dress forms (male, female).

C. Workshop layout and workflow

The physical arrangement of your workshop significantly impacts efficiency and safety.

- **Workflow:** The logical sequence of tasks (e.g., Measuring -> Drafting -> Cutting -> Sewing -> Fitting -> Finishing -> Pressing -> Packaging).
- **Layout types:**
 - **Process layout (functional):** Grouping similar machines or activities together (e.g., all cutting tables in one area, all sewing machines in another). Good for custom/varied orders.
 - **Product layout (line):** Arranging machines and stations in the exact sequence of production. Good for mass-producing a single item.
- **Key considerations:**

- **Lighting:** Excellent lighting (natural and artificial) is non-negotiable, especially over cutting and sewing areas.
- **Ventilation:** Good airflow to manage fabric dust and heat from machines.
- **Safety:** Clear pathways, fire extinguisher, first-aid box, no exposed wires.

D. Personnel (staffing)

Even a small shop may require help. Common roles include:

- **Master tailor/designer (the owner):** Oversees all operations, handles design and complex tasks.
- **Apprentices/trainees:** Learn the trade while assisting with basic tasks (e.g., cutting, finishing, running errands).
- **Machinists:** Skilled individuals who specialize in operating sewing machines.
- **Customer service/receptionist:** Manages client appointments, orders, and inquiries.

Evaluation questions

1. Define "Capital" and list three common sources of capital for a small business.
2. What is the difference between a "Process Layout" and a "Product Layout"?
3. Why is good ventilation important in a fashion workshop?
4. List three legal steps you must take before opening a workshop.
5. Name three essential pieces of furniture for a workshop, apart from machines.

Assignment questions

1. You have been given a grant of ₦500,000 to set up a small fashion workshop. Create a detailed budget breakdown showing how you would allocate this capital (list at least 8 items and their estimated costs).
2. Which workshop layout (Process or Product) would you recommend for a new tailoring business specializing in bespoke (custom-made) native wear, and why?
3. Discuss the importance of "Location" for a new fashion business. List five key factors to consider when choosing a location in your specific local government area.

4. Draw a simple floor plan for a small, efficient fashion workshop. Label the key areas: (1) Cutting Station, (2) Sewing Station (for 2 machines), (3) Pressing Area, (4) Fitting Area/Mirror, (5) Storage.
5. Research and list the current requirements and approximate cost to register a "Business Name" with the Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC) in Nigeria.



WEEK 3: TAILORING BUSINESS II

TOPIC: COSTING & PRICING GARMENTS

Introduction

Costing and pricing are the most critical financial activities for a fashion business. "Costing" is understanding what you spend, and "Pricing" is deciding what you charge. Many skilled tailors fail not because of their craft, but because they do not price their work profitably.

A. Definition of key terms

- **Cost:** The total amount of money spent to produce a single garment.
- **Price:** The amount of money a customer pays for the garment ($\text{Price} = \text{Cost} + \text{Profit}$).
- **Profit:** The money left over after all costs have been paid ($\text{Profit} = \text{Price} - \text{Cost}$).

B. Types of costs

1. Direct costs

These are expenses directly tied to the creation of a specific garment. They are easy to trace.

- **Fabric:** The main material.
- **Trimmings & notions:** Zippers, buttons, thread, interfacing, lining, stones, beads.
- **Direct labour:** The wages paid to the person who sewed the garment (if you pay per item)
OR your own "wage" for the time spent.

2. Indirect costs (overheads)

These are the general expenses of running the business, not tied to one specific garment. They must be shared among all the garments you produce.

- **Rent:** Workshop rent.
- **Utilities:** Electricity (NEPA/generator fuel), water.
- **Equipment:** Depreciation or repair of sewing machines, iron.

- **Indirect labour:** Salary for a receptionist, security, or your own "salary" as the business manager.
- **Other:** Business registration fees, marketing costs, bank charges.

3. Fixed vs. variable costs

- **Fixed costs:** Stay the same each month, regardless of how many clothes you make (e.g., Rent, basic salary).
- **Variable costs:** Change based on production. The more clothes you make, the higher they get (e.g., Fabric, thread, electricity).

C. The costing process: How to cost a single garment

To make a profit, you **MUST** know the cost of *every single item* you produce.

Step 1: Calculate direct material cost (dmc)

- Cost of main fabric (e.g., 4 yards of Ankara @ ₦1,500/yard = ₦6,000)
- Cost of lining (e.g., 2 yards @ ₦500/yard = ₦1,000)
- Cost of trimmings (e.g., 1 zipper @ ₦150, 1 spool thread @ ₦200 = ₦350)
- **Total dmc = ₦6,000 + ₦1,000 + ₦350 = ₦7,350**

Step 2: Calculate direct labour cost (dlc)

- This is the time it takes to make the garment. You must pay yourself (or your staff) a wage.
- e.g., Time taken = 5 hours
- Your hourly rate = ₦1,000/hour (This is your "skill wage")
- **Total dlc = 5 hours * ₦1,000/hour = ₦5,000**

Step 3: Calculate overhead cost (oc) per item

- This is the trickiest part. You must "allocate" a small piece of your total monthly overheads to this one garment.

- **Method:**

1. Calculate total monthly overheads (e.g., Rent ₦20,000 + Fuel ₦10,000 + Admin ₦5,000 = ₦35,000)
2. Estimate how many garments you make per month (e.g., 25 garments)
3. Divide Overheads by Garments: ₦35,000 / 25 = ₦1,400

- **Total oc per garment = ₦1,400**

Step 4: Calculate total cost

- Total Cost = DMC + DLC + OC
- Total Cost = ₦7,350 + ₦5,000 + ₦1,400 = **₦13,750**

D. Pricing strategies: Setting the final price

Now that you know your *cost* is ₦13,750, you can set a *price*.

1. Cost-plus pricing (markup)

- This is the simplest method. You add a percentage (markup) to your total cost. This percentage is your *profit margin*.
- Let's use a 50% markup (a good starting point).
- Markup Amount = 50% of ₦13,750 = ₦6,875
- **Final Price = Total Cost + Markup**
- **Final Price = ₦13,750 + ₦6,875 = ₦20,625**
- (You might round this to ₦20,500 or ₦21,000)

2. Value-based pricing

- This is based on the *perceived value* to the customer, not your cost.
- Is this a complex *haute couture* design? Is it for a celebrity? Is your brand highly sought-after?
- You might charge ₦50,000 for the same garment, even if it only cost ₦13,750 to make, because your *brand* and *skill* are valuable.

3. Competitive pricing

- This involves setting your price based on what your competitors are charging for similar items.
- If other tailors of your skill level charge ₦18,000 for a similar dress, you might price yours at ₦18,000, even though your cost-plus price was ₦20,625 (meaning you'd make less profit) or ₦17,500 (to try and win customers).
- **Danger:** This can lead to a "race to the bottom" where no one makes a profit.

Evaluation questions

1. Define "Cost," "Price," and "Profit" in your own words.
2. What is the difference between a "Fixed Cost" and a "Variable Cost"?
3. List three examples of "Direct Costs."
4. List three examples of "Indirect Costs (Overheads)."
5. What is "Cost-Plus Pricing"?

Assignment questions

1. Explain the danger of using "Competitive Pricing" as your only strategy.
2. A customer brings you 6 yards of lace fabric (which they bought themselves) to make a complex *Iro* and *Buba*. You will need to buy lining, thread, and a zipper. The style requires 8 hours of complex sewing. Explain, step-by-step, how you would "cost" this job (list the costs you would need to calculate).
3. **Practical Calculation:**
 - Fabric: 3 yards @ ₦2,000/yard
 - Trimmings (Lining, Zipper, Thread): ₦1,500
 - Labour: 4 hours @ ₦800/hour
 - Allocated Overhead: ₦1,000
 - **Task:** (a) Calculate the Total Cost. (b) Calculate the Final Price using a 60% markup.
4. Explain "Value-Based Pricing." Why might a designer like *Deola Sagoe* charge ₦500,000 for a dress that costs ₦50,000 to produce?

5. For one week, track the cost of electricity in your home or workshop (e.g., how much generator fuel is used, or how much is spent on prepaid tokens). This will help you understand how to calculate "Overheads."



WEEK 4: CUSTOMER RELATIONS

TOPIC: COMMUNICATION, TAKING ORDERS, HANDLING COMPLAINTS

Introduction

In the fashion business, your product is only half the story. The other half is the *service*. Excellent customer relations build trust, create loyalty, and generate positive word-of-mouth referrals. Poor customer service can destroy a business, no matter how skilled the tailor.

A. The importance of customer relations

- **Customer retention:** It is cheaper to keep an existing customer than to find a new one. Happy customers return.
- **Brand reputation:** A good reputation for service makes you stand out from competitors.
- **Word-of-mouth marketing:** Happy customers become your best advertisers.
- **Valuable feedback:** Customers provide insights into what you are doing right and wrong.

B. Effective communication

1. Verbal communication

- **Tone & language:** Speak clearly, politely, and confidently. Use respectful terms (Ma'am, Sir).
- **Clarity:** Explain complex tailoring terms in simple language. Be clear about pickup dates and prices.
- **Avoid jargon:** Don't assume the customer knows what a "French seam" or "sloper" is.
- **Honesty:** Be honest about timelines. It is better to say "It will be ready in 2 weeks" and deliver, than to say "5 days" and disappoint.

2. Non-verbal communication

- **Body language:** Maintain eye contact, smile, and have an open posture.

- **Environment:** Your workshop should be clean and organized. This communicates professionalism.
- **Appearance:** As a fashion professional, you should look neat and presentable.

3. Active listening

- **Definition:** This is listening to *understand*, not just to reply.
- **How to do it:**
 - Give the customer your full attention.
 - Don't interrupt.
 - Nod and give verbal cues ("I see," "Okay," "I understand").
 - Ask clarifying questions ("So, you want the neckline to be V-shaped, not round?").
 - Summarize their request at the end to confirm.

C. Taking accurate orders & measurements

This is a critical point where many errors occur.

- **The consultation:**
 - Discuss the style. Use sketch pads or style catalogues.
 - Advise on fabric suitability. (e.g., "Ma'am, this stiff fabric won't be good for the flowing style you want.>").
 - Be clear on the *exact* design.
- **Taking measurements:**
 - Use a professional, non-stretch tape measure.
 - Be systematic (e.g., top-to-bottom).
 - Ensure the tape is snug but not tight.
 - Respect the customer's personal space and be professional.
- **Recording:** Write all measurements legibly on a dedicated order form or measurement card for that client. Include:
 - Customer Name & Phone Number
 - Fabric Type
 - Style Description/Sketch

- All Measurements (Bust, Waist, Hip, Shoulder, etc.)
- Price Quoted & Deposit Paid
- Collection Date

D. Handling customer complaints

Complaints are inevitable. How you handle them defines your business.

- **View complaints as a gift:** The customer is giving you a chance to fix a problem, instead of just leaving and telling 10 people about their bad experience.
- **The "H.E.A.T." method:**
 - **H - Hear them out:** Listen to their entire complaint without interrupting. Let them vent their frustration.
 - **E - Empathize:** Show that you understand their feeling. Use phrases like, "I understand why you are upset," or "I'm so sorry this has happened."
 - **A - Apologize:** Give a sincere apology. Even if you think they are wrong, apologize for *their experience*. "I apologize that this wasn't to your satisfaction."
 - **T - Take action (and responsibility):**
 - Offer a clear solution. "I will fix the sleeve right now. Please give me 30 minutes."
 - If it's a major issue: "This was our error. We will remake the dress for you at no extra charge."
 - Never blame the customer ("You've added weight") or your staff ("It was my apprentice"). *You* are the business owner. Take responsibility.

E. Building customer loyalty

- Deliver on time, every time.
- Ensure perfect finishing.
- Send a "Thank You" SMS after a purchase.
- Offer small benefits for repeat customers (e.g., a small discount, a free accessory).
- Remember their names and preferences.

Evaluation questions

1. Why is customer retention important?
2. What is "Active Listening"?
3. List 5 key pieces of information that must be on a customer's order form.
4. What does each letter in the "H.E.A.T." method stand for?
5. List two examples of non-verbal communication.

Assignment questions

1. Design a comprehensive "Customer Order Form" on a sheet of paper. It should include all the necessary fields to prevent mistakes.
2. A customer comes to pick up her dress and is very angry. The fitting is poor, and the colour of the thread used does not match the fabric. Write a short script of *exactly* what you would say and do, following the H.E.A.T. method.
3. Discuss three ways a fashion designer can build customer loyalty, apart from the ones listed in the notes.
4. Why is it a bad idea to blame your apprentice or staff when a customer complains?
5. Pair up with a partner. One person is a difficult customer who wants a complex style made from an unsuitable fabric (e.g., a structured blazer from soft chiffon). The other is the tailor. Write a short dialogue where the tailor politely and professionally guides the customer toward a better option without losing the sale.

WEEK 5: MIDTERM TEST

This week is dedicated to the midterm test, which will cover all material from Weeks 1-4.

- **Section A:** Objective questions on SS1/SS2 review, tools, and terminology.
- **Section B:** Short-answer questions on setting up a workshop and customer relations.
- **Section C:** Practical calculation question on costing and pricing a garment.



WEEK 6: ENTREPRENEURSHIP IN FASHION

TOPIC: BRANDING, MARKETING, SALES

Introduction

Having a skill (being a good tailor) is different from owning a business (being a fashion entrepreneur). Entrepreneurship is the act of building a sustainable, profitable business around your skill. This requires a new set of tools: branding, marketing, and sales.

A. What is fashion entrepreneurship?

It is the process of identifying a gap or need in the fashion market and creating a business to fill that need, managing the financial risks in order to make a profit. It's not just about sewing; it's about building a *name* and a *system*.

B. Branding: Creating your identity

Your brand is not just your logo. It is your *reputation*. It's what people feel and say about your business when you're not in the room.

- **1. Niche:** Who are you for? You cannot be for everyone.
 - *Examples:* "The best *Aso Ebi* tailor in Surulere," "Affordable corporate wear for working women," "Edgy streetwear for university students," "Luxury children's wear."
- **2. Brand identity:**
 - **Business name:** Must be memorable, professional, and easy to spell.
 - **Logo & colours:** A simple, professional logo and a consistent colour palette.
 - **Tagline:** A short, catchy phrase (e.g., "Your Style, Perfected").
- **3. Brand voice:** How do you communicate? Are you "luxe and exclusive" or "friendly and affordable"? This must be consistent on social media and in person.
- **4. Packaging:** How do customers receive their garments? In a plain nylon bag, or in a branded paper bag/box? Packaging enhances perceived value.

C. Marketing: Getting noticed

Marketing is the process of telling your target customers (your *niche*) that your brand exists and why they should choose you.

- **The 4 Ps of marketing:**

- **Product:** What you sell. Must be high-quality and solve the customer's problem (e.g., "I need a beautiful dress for a wedding").
- **Price:** What you charge. Must be consistent with your brand (e.g., a "luxury" brand cannot have "cheap" prices).
- **Place:** Where you sell. Your workshop, an e-commerce website, a social media page (Instagram, Facebook), a market stall.
- **Promotion:** How you tell people.
 - **Word of mouth:** Your best tool. Deliver excellent work.
 - **Social media:** Post high-quality photos of your work, "behind-the-scenes" videos.
 - **Collaborations:** Work with makeup artists, photographers, and event planners.
 - **Business cards/flyers:** Professional and well-designed.

D. Sales: Making the money

Sales is the process of converting an *interested person* (a lead) into a *paying customer*.

- **Sales channels:**

- **Offline:** Walk-in customers, referrals, fashion fairs.
- **Online:** Selling directly through Instagram/WhatsApp DMs, a simple website.

- **The sales process:**

1. **Greet & consult:** (See Week 4) Build rapport and understand their needs.
2. **Present a solution:** Show them how your skill/design will meet their needs.

3. **Handle objections:** If they say, "It's too expensive," don't just drop the price. Explain the *value* (e.g., "It's this price because we use high-quality lining and the stoning is all done by hand, so it will last you for years.").
4. **Close the sale:** Ask for the order and collect a deposit. (e.g., "So, shall we proceed? We require a 60% deposit to secure your fabric.").
5. **Follow-up:** After-sales service (Week 4).

Evaluation questions

1. What is fashion entrepreneurship?
2. Explain the difference between "Marketing" and "Sales."
3. What is a "niche" in fashion?
4. List the "4 Ps of Marketing."
5. Why is good packaging important for a fashion brand?

Assignment questions

1. Develop a complete brand identity for your *own* future fashion business. Include: (a) Business Name, (b) Niche, (c) Tagline, and (d) A description of your ideal customer.
2. A potential customer says, "Your price is too high! My regular tailor only charges half of that." Write a polite and professional response that handles this objection *without* lowering your price.
3. Create a one-month marketing plan for a new fashion business. List three activities you would do each week to promote the business.
4. Find two local fashion designers on Instagram. Analyze their "brand voice" (e.g., are they friendly, formal, luxurious, edgy?) and their "brand identity" (e.g., logo, colours).
5. Design a simple business card for your hypothetical fashion business. Include your business name, tagline, phone number, and social media handle.

WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

This week is for the midterm break. Students are encouraged to rest and also reflect on the business concepts learned in the first half of the term.

WEEK 8: ICT IN FASHION

TOPIC: ONLINE MARKETING, FASHION SOFTWARE

Introduction

Information and Communication Technology (ICT) has revolutionized the fashion industry. From design to marketing, technology is no longer an option—it's a necessity for growth, efficiency, and staying competitive. For a modern designer, your phone and computer are as important as your sewing machine.

A. ICT in fashion: The overview

ICT refers to all technologies used to handle information and communication. In fashion, this includes:

- Social Media
- E-commerce Websites
- Design Software (CAD)
- Communication tools (WhatsApp, Email)
- Sourcing platforms (Alibaba, online fabric stores)

B. Online marketing & digital presence

This is the most accessible and powerful use of ICT for a small business.

1. Social media marketing

- **Platforms:**
 - **Instagram:** The most important. It's visual. Perfect for showing finished garments, behind-the-scenes, and video reels of the process.
 - **Pinterest:** A visual search engine. Great for creating "mood boards" and attracting clients looking for inspiration.

- **Facebook:** Good for building a community, sharing business updates, and running targeted ads.
- **TikTok/Reels:** Short video content is highly engaging. Show a "before and after" transformation or a quick sewing tip.
- **Best practices:**
 - **High-quality photos:** This is non-negotiable. Bad, dark, or blurry photos will kill your brand. Use good lighting (natural light is best) and a clean background.
 - **Consistency:** Post regularly (e.g., 3-5 times a week).
 - **Engagement:** Reply to comments and DMs promptly and professionally.
 - **Hashtags:** Use relevant hashtags (e.g., #LagosFashion, #AsoEbiBella, #NigerianDesigner) to be discovered.

2. E-commerce

- **Definition:** Selling your products online.
- **Methods:**
 - **Social commerce:** Selling directly through Instagram/WhatsApp. This is where most small businesses start.
 - **Marketplaces:** Selling on platforms like Jumia or Konga (though less common for custom fashion).
 - **E-commerce website:** Having your own website (e.g., using Shopify or Wix). This is more professional and gives you full control.

3. The digital portfolio

- Instead of a physical photo album, your online presence (especially Instagram) acts as your portfolio. It's a living, shareable catalogue of your best work that clients can review anytime.

C. Fashion software

1. Computer-aided design (cad)

- **What it is:** Software used to design and visualize garments on a computer.
- **Types:**
 - **2D design:** Software like Adobe Illustrator or CorelDRAW. Used for creating fashion sketches (flats), print designs, and tech packs.
 - **3D design:** Advanced software (e.g., CLO 3D, Marvelous Designer). Allows you to create a 3D virtual prototype of a garment, "drape" it on a virtual model, and see how it fits and moves without ever cutting fabric. This saves time and waste.
- **Benefits:**
 - **Accuracy:** Create precise patterns.
 - **Speed:** Make changes (e.g., change colour, sleeve length) with a click.
 - **Visualization:** Show a client *exactly* what the garment will look like.

2. Pattern making software

- Software like AutoCAD, Gerber, or Lectra is used in industry to digitally create, grade (resize), and lay out patterns efficiently for manufacturing.

3. Business management software

- Simple tools like Microsoft Excel or Google Sheets can be used to track finances, customer orders, and measurements.

Evaluation questions

1. What does "ICT" stand for?
2. Why is Instagram considered a powerful marketing tool for fashion?
3. What is "E-commerce"?
4. What is "Social Commerce"?
5. What is the main benefit of using 3D CAD software?

Assignment questions

1. List five "best practices" for taking high-quality photos of your garments using only a smartphone. (Hint: think about lighting, background, angles).

2. What is the difference between 2D and 3D CAD software in fashion design?
3. Explain "Social Commerce." Describe the step-by-step process of selling a ready-to-wear dress to a customer through Instagram DMs, from the customer's first message to payment.
4. Create an Instagram post for a garment you have made. Write an engaging caption, and list at least 5 relevant hashtags you would use.
5. Go to Pinterest and create a "mood board" for a new fashion collection. (A mood board is a collection of images, colours, and textures that inspire a design).



WEEK 9: FASHION TRENDS & GLOBALIZATION

TOPIC: INFLUENCES OF GLOBAL FASHION

Introduction

The fashion world is no longer isolated. What is worn in Lagos is influenced by trends in Paris, and what is designed in Accra can become a global phenomenon. This interconnectedness is "globalization," and it is driven by technology, media, and travel. Understanding this helps a designer stay relevant and find new opportunities.

A. Key definitions

- **Fashion trend:** A style or look that is popular among a large group of people at a particular time.
- **Trend cycle:** The "life" of a trend, which usually follows five stages:
 1. **Introduction:** A new style is worn by innovators (e.g., celebrities, designers).
 2. **Rise:** The style is adopted by "fashion leaders" and seen in magazines/blogs.
 3. **Peak:** The style is at its most popular and is mass-produced.
 4. **Decline:** The style becomes oversaturated and "common."
 5. **Obsolescence (rejection):** The style is no longer fashionable.
- **Globalization:** The process of businesses and cultures interacting and integrating on an international scale.

B. Positive influences of globalization

- **Cultural exchange & inspiration:**
 - Designers can draw inspiration from all over the world (e.g., Japanese kimono silhouettes, Indian embroidery techniques, Scottish tartan).
 - The world has embraced African prints (*Ankara*, *Kente*). Nigerian designers are now "exporting" their culture by showcasing *Aso Ebi* and *Agbada* on a global stage.

- **Access to global markets:** A Nigerian designer can now sell to a customer in London or New York via an e-commerce website and social media.
- **Access to materials:** Designers can source high-quality fabrics, trimmings, and even machines from anywhere in the world (e.g., via online platforms like Alibaba).
- **Global trend awareness:** The internet (blogs, Instagram, Vogue) allows a designer in Nigeria to see the latest runway shows from Paris, Milan, and New York in real-time.

C. Negative influences of globalization

- **Fast fashion:**
 - **Definition:** Inexpensive, rapidly produced clothing by mass-market retailers (like Shein, Zara) in response to the latest trends.
 - **Impact:** It creates a "disposable" culture where clothes are worn a few times and thrown away. It puts pressure on local tailors to compete with extremely low prices.
- **Loss of cultural identity:** The dominance of Western fashion trends (e.g., jeans and T-shirts) can sometimes threaten the production and appreciation of traditional local garments.
- **Sustainability & ethical issues:** The demand for cheap clothes can lead to poor working conditions in factories (sweatshops) and significant environmental pollution.

D. The designer's role

A modern Nigerian designer must navigate these influences by:

- **Being authentic:** Don't just copy global trends. Find a way to *interpret* them, blending them with your own unique style or with local cultural elements (e.g., "How can I use *Adire* fabric to create a modern blazer?").
- **Focusing on quality:** You cannot compete with "fast fashion" on price. You must compete on *quality*, *craftsmanship*, and *custom fit*—things a factory cannot offer.
- **Embracing sustainability:** Emphasize quality over quantity. Promote "slow fashion"—the idea of creating timeless, well-made garments that last for years.

Evaluation questions

1. What is a "Fashion Trend"?
2. List the five stages of the "Fashion Trend Cycle."
3. What is "Globalization"?
4. Define "Fast Fashion."
5. What is "Slow Fashion"?

Assignment questions

1. Describe a fashion trend you have seen recently. At what stage of the trend cycle do you think it is (Introduction, Rise, Peak, Decline) and why?
2. List two positive and two negative impacts of globalization on the Nigerian fashion industry.
3. What is "Cultural Exchange" in fashion? Give an example of a Nigerian design element being used globally AND a global design element being used in Nigeria.
4. How can a local tailor stay competitive in a world full of cheap, "fast fashion" imports? (Discuss at least two strategies).
5. Research the term "Sustainability" in fashion. Write one paragraph explaining what it means and why it is important.

WEEK 10: PRACTICAL: BUSINESS PROPOSAL FOR A FASHION LINE

TOPIC: CREATING A FASHION BUSINESS PROPOSAL

Introduction

A business proposal (or business plan) is a formal, written document that outlines your business goals and how you plan to achieve them. It is your "blueprint" for success. You need it to get loans, attract investors, or simply to guide your own strategic decisions. This week is a practical exercise in creating one.

A. Why create a business proposal?

- To test the *viability* of your business idea (Will this actually work?).
- To secure *funding* (loans, grants, investors).
- To create a *roadmap* for yourself and your team.
- To force you to think through every aspect of the business.

B. Key components of a fashion business proposal

A simple but effective proposal should include the following sections:

1. Executive summary

- A short, 1-page overview of the *entire* plan.
- Write this section LAST, but place it FIRST.
- It should summarize your business name, mission, product, target market, and financial goals.

2. Business description

- **Business name:** (e.g., "Amara's Kouture")
- **Mission statement:** What is the purpose of your business? (e.g., "To provide modern, professional women in Lagos with high-quality, custom-fit corporate wear.")
- **Business structure:** Sole Proprietorship, Partnership, etc.

- **Goals & objectives:** (e.g., "To open a 100-sq-ft workshop within 6 months" or "To achieve ₦1,000,000 in sales in the first year.")

3. Products & services

- Be specific. What *exactly* will you sell?
- *Examples:* "Bespoke (custom-made) native wear for men," "Ready-to-wear casual dresses," "Aso Ebi tailoring services," "Fashion illustration services."
- Describe your production process (e.g., "All items will be designed and produced in-house at our workshop").

4. Market analysis

- **Target market (your niche):** Who is your ideal customer? Be detailed. (e.g., "Working women, aged 25-40, living in Ikeja, with a moderate income, who value quality and fit").
- **Competition:** Who are your main competitors? (e.g., "Other tailors in the area, online fashion stores.").
- **SWOT analysis:**
 - Strengths: (e.g., "My unique design skill," "Low overheads").
 - Weaknesses: (e.g., "No business experience," "Limited capital").
 - Opportunities: (e.g., "Growing demand for Aso Ebi," "Few competitors in my niche").
 - Threats: (e.g., "Rising cost of fabric," "Poor electricity supply").

5. Marketing & sales plan

- (See Week 6)
- **Branding:** How will you position your brand? (e.g., "As an affordable-luxury brand").
- **Marketing (promotion):** How will you reach your target market? (e.g., "Primarily through Instagram marketing, collaborations with influencers, and word-of-mouth.").
- **Sales:** How will you make sales? (e.g., "Directly from our workshop and via WhatsApp orders.").

6. Financial plan

- This is the most important part for investors.
- **Start-up costs:** A detailed list of everything you need to buy to start (See Week 2). (e.g., Industrial Machine - ₦80,000; Rent (1yr) - ₦120,000; etc.).
- **Financial projections:** A "best guess" of your sales and profit for the first 1-3 years.
- **Funding request (if applicable):** Exactly how much money you are asking for and what you will use it for.

C. Practical assignment

Students will spend this week's class time drafting their own simple 3-5 page business proposal for a hypothetical fashion line they wish to start.

Evaluation questions

1. What is a business proposal?
2. List the 6 key components of a business proposal.
3. What is the purpose of an "Executive Summary"?
4. What does "SWOT" stand for?
5. What is a "Mission Statement"?

Assignment questions

1. Write a "Mission Statement" for your own hypothetical fashion business.
2. Define a "Target Market" for your business. Be specific (age, gender, location, income, interests).
3. Conduct a brief "SWOT Analysis" for your hypothetical new tailoring business. List at least two points for each (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats).
4. Create a detailed "Start-up Cost" budget for your dream fashion business. List at least 10 different items and their estimated costs.
5. **PRACTICAL:** Write the "Products & Services" section for your business proposal. Be very specific about what you will sell.

WEEK 11-13: REVISION & EXAMS

- **WEEK 11:** Comprehensive review of all topics from Week 1 to Week 10. Focus on business concepts, costing, and marketing.
- **WEEK 12:** First Term Examination (Theory).
- **WEEK 13:** First Term Examination (Practical - e.g., "Cost a complex garment" or "Draft a business proposal summary").



SS3 FASHION DESIGN & GARMENT MAKING LESSON NOTES

SECOND TERM

WEEK 1: REVISION OF MAJOR SKILLS

TOPIC: GARMENT CONSTRUCTION TECHNIQUES

Introduction

This term is dedicated to perfecting your practical skills for the final SSCE examination. This week, we will conduct an intensive review of the most common and complex garment construction techniques that are frequently tested. Mastery of these skills is essential for success.

A. Review of advanced seams and finishes

- **French seam:** A self-enclosed seam used on sheer or delicate fabrics.
- **Flat-felled seam:** A strong, durable seam used for sportswear, jeans, and men's shirts (two rows of stitching are visible on the outside).
- **Seam finishes:** Review of overlocking (serging), zigzag, pinking, and turning/stitching.

B. Mastering complex collars

- **Shirt collar with a stand:** This is a two-piece collar (the collar itself and the stand it sits on). We will review drafting and attaching it neatly to a neckline.
- **Shawl collar:** A one-piece collar that is cut as part of the main bodice front, common on smoking jackets or robes. Focus on the 'V' point at the back neck.
- **Peter Pan/Flat collar:** Review of drafting, attaching, and understitching for a flat, neat finish.

C. Mastering advanced openings

- **Bound buttonholes:** A high-end finish where the buttonhole is created using small strips of fabric, rather than machine stitching.

- **Lapped zipper:** A classic zipper application where one side of the placket overlaps and hides the zipper teeth.
- **Fly-front zipper:** The standard application for trousers and jeans, involving a fly, a fly shield, and specific topstitching.

D. Mastering advanced pockets

- **Welt pocket:** A sophisticated pocket used on suit jackets, vests, and trousers. It involves cutting a slash in the garment and concealing the pocket bag behind a small, neat fabric "welt."
- **Jetted pocket (Bound pocket):** Similar to a welt, but with two narrow fabric "jets" (lips) forming the opening.

E. Attaching linings

- **"Bagging out" a lining:** The industrial technique for attaching a full lining to a garment (like a sleeveless bodice or a jacket) at the neckline and armholes, turning it right-side out through an opening, and achieving a clean, enclosed finish.
- **Understitching:** The crucial step of stitching the lining to the seam allowance, which prevents the lining from rolling to the outside of the garment.

Evaluation questions

1. What is the main difference between a French seam and a flat-felled seam?
2. On what type of garment would you typically find a welt pocket?
3. What is the purpose of "understitching" a lining?
4. Differentiate between a shawl collar and a shirt collar with a stand.
5. What is the primary advantage of a bound buttonhole over a machine buttonhole?

Assignment questions

1. On a scrap piece of fabric (at least 12x12 inches), create two sample pockets: a patch pocket and a practice welt pocket. Label them clearly.
2. Draw and label the pattern pieces for a two-piece shirt collar (the collar and the stand).

3. Describe, in steps, the process of "bagging out" a lining on a sleeveless bodice.
4. Research and explain the difference between a "lapped zipper" and a "centred zipper" application.
5. List five "finishing" techniques that separate a low-quality garment from a high-quality one.



WEEK 2: SSCE PAST QUESTIONS – THEORY

TOPIC: WORKED SOLUTIONS

Introduction

The SSCE theory exam tests your entire knowledge from SS1 to SS3. Success depends on understanding *how* to answer the questions correctly. This week, we will deconstruct past questions, identify key topics, and practice writing perfect answers.

A. Understanding the exam structure

- **Paper 1 (Objectives):** Multiple-choice questions (usually 40-50 questions) covering the entire syllabus. They test recall and identification.
- **Paper 2 (Theory/Essay):** Requires longer, written answers. This paper is typically divided into sections:
 - Section A: Shorter, compulsory questions (e.g., "List..." or "Define...").
 - Section B: Longer essay-style questions, often with choices (e.g., "Describe..." or "Explain...").

B. Frequently tested topics

- **Safety:** Workshop safety rules, types of accidents, first aid.
- **Tools & equipment:** Identification, uses, and maintenance.
- **Fibres & fabrics:** Classification (natural, synthetic), properties, burn test.
- **Design:** Elements and principles of design.
- **Garment construction:** Seams, darts, fullness, openings, pockets, collars.
- **Pattern drafting:** Terminology, symbols, layout.
- **Business:** Costing, pricing, customer relations, entrepreneurship (from Term 1).

C. Worked solutions: Strategies

1. "List" or "State" questions:

- **Keyword:** List, State, Name.
- **Strategy:** Be direct and to the point. Do not write essays. Use bullet points or numbers.
- **Example Q:** "List four types of measuring tools used in garment making."
- **Worked Answer:**
 1. Measuring Tape: For taking body measurements.
 2. Ruler: For drawing straight lines on patterns.
 3. Seam Gauge: For measuring short distances like hems or seam allowances.
 4. L-Square/Tailor's Square: For drafting patterns and establishing 90-degree angles.

2. "Explain" or "Describe" questions:

- **Keyword:** Explain, Describe, Discuss.
- **Strategy:** This requires a process or detailed description. Use clear, sequential steps (1, 2, 3...) or full sentences in a logical paragraph.
- **Example Q:** "Describe the steps for making a plain seam."
- **Worked Answer:**
 1. Place the two pieces of fabric "right sides" together, aligning the raw edges.
 2. Pin the fabric in place, perpendicular to the seam line.
 3. Stitch along the designated seam allowance (e.g., 1.5cm or 5/8 inch), backstitching at the beginning and end.
 4. Remove the pins.
 5. Press the seam allowances open or to one side, as required by the design.
 6. Finish the raw edges (e.g., with an overlocker or zigzag stitch) to prevent fraying.

3. "Differentiate" or "Compare" questions:

- **Keyword:** Differentiate, Compare, Distinguish.
- **Strategy:** Use a table for maximum clarity, or use clear comparative language ("...while..." or "...whereas...").
- **Example Q:** "Differentiate between a flat-felled seam and a French seam."
- **Worked Answer:**

Feature	Flat-Felled Seam	French Seam
Appearance	Two rows of stitching visible on the outside.	No stitching visible on the

outside. | | **Construction** | Seam allowances are enclosed and topstitched flat. | Seam allowances are enclosed within a second seam. | | **Use** | Strong, durable. Used for jeans, sportswear, men's shirts. | Neat finish. Used for delicate, sheer fabrics (e.g., chiffon, organza). |

Evaluation questions

1. What is the main difference between an "Objective" question and a "Theory" question?
2. What is the best way to answer a question that asks you to "Differentiate"?
3. Name three frequently tested topics in the theory exam.
4. When a question says "List," should you write in paragraphs? Why or why not?
5. What is the purpose of backstitching when using a sewing machine?

Assignment questions

(Using past SSCE question papers)

1. Find and answer a question that asks you to "Define" five fashion terminologies.
2. Find and answer a question that asks you to "Explain" the elements of design.
3. Find and answer a question that asks you to "Describe" the safety precautions to be taken when using a sewing machine.
4. Find and answer a question that asks you to "List" the properties of cotton fabric.
5. Find and answer a question that asks you to "Differentiate" between costing and pricing a garment.

WEEK 3: SSCE PAST QUESTIONS – PRACTICAL

TOPIC: GARMENT MAKING PRACTICE

Introduction

The practical exam (Paper 3) is a test of your skill, speed, and ability to interpret instructions under pressure. It typically lasts 3 hours. This week, we will analyze the structure of the practical exam and practice a common test project.

A. Understanding the practical exam

- **The brief:** You will be given a "brief" (instructions) and a diagram for a garment (e.g., a child's dress, a blouse, shorts) or a set of technical samples (e.g., "produce a welt pocket and a bound buttonhole").
- **The specimen list:** You will have received a "specimen list" weeks in advance, telling you what materials to bring (e.g., "1.5m of cotton fabric," "matching thread," "buttons," "zipper").
- **The marking:** You are graded on a strict marking scheme.

B. The SSCE marking scheme: What are they looking for?

1. **Interpretation (20%):** Did you make the correct garment? Did you include all features (e.g., the pocket, the collar, the darts)?
2. **Pattern/Cutting (20%):** Is your pattern accurate? Is the garment cut on the correct grainline? Are the pieces neat?
3. **Construction/Sewing (40%):**
 - Are the stitches straight and the tension correct?
 - Are the seams neat and correctly finished?
 - Are complex parts (collar, zipper, pocket) attached correctly?
 - Is the garment symmetrical?
4. **Finishing (20%):**
 - Is the garment well-pressed?

- Are all loose threads trimmed?
- Are buttons and fasteners sewn on neatly and securely?
- Is the hem even?

C. Time management: The 3-hour plan

This is the most critical part. You must not run out of time.

- **0:00 – 0:15 (15 mins):** Read and understand the brief. Lay out your tools.
- **0:15 – 0:45 (30 mins):** Draft your pattern and lay it out on the fabric.
- **0:45 – 1:00 (15 mins):** Cut the fabric and transfer all markings (darts, notches).
- **1:00 – 2:30 (1 hr 30 mins):** Construction and sewing. Do the most complex parts first (e.g., pocket, zipper) while you are fresh.
- **2:30 – 3:00 (30 mins):** Finishing. Hemming, buttons, final pressing, and trimming threads.

D. In-class practice: The welt pocket sample

Today, we will practice a common, high-skill task: a mock welt pocket.

- **Objective:** To create a perfect 4-inch welt pocket sample on a 10x10 inch piece of fabric.
- **Steps:**
 1. Prepare main fabric, interfacing, pocket bag pieces, and welt piece.
 2. Interface the back of the main fabric where the pocket will be.
 3. Mark the pocket opening (a 4-inch line) on the right side of the fabric.
 4. Prepare and attach the welt and pocket bag pieces.
 5. Stitch the "box" around the marked line.
 6. Slash the opening carefully, clipping to the corners.
 7. Turn the pocket bag and welt to the inside.
 8. Press the welt into position.
 9. Stitch the pocket bag closed.
 10. Give the sample a final, crisp press.

Evaluation questions

1. What is a "specimen list"?
2. In a 3-hour practical, roughly how much time should be given to "Finishing"?
3. List the four main categories in a typical SSCE practical marking scheme.
4. Why is it important to cut on the correct grainline?
5. What is the first thing you should do when the exam begins?

Assignment questions

1. Write out a personal "Time Management Plan" for a 3-hour practical exam, breaking it down into 30-minute intervals.
2. Assemble your "SSCE Practical Exam Kit." Lay all the tools out and take a picture. (Your kit should include: shears, paper scissors, pins, needles, seam ripper, chalk, measuring tape, rulers, curves, threads, etc.).
3. On a new piece of fabric, create a second practice welt pocket to perfect your technique from class.
4. Research and draw the diagrams for three different types of "fullness." (e.g., Gathers, Pleats, Tucks).
5. Practice and create a sample of a "bound buttonhole."

WEEK 4: MOCK PROJECT I

TOPIC: DESIGNING & CUTTING

Introduction

For the next few weeks (Weeks 4, 6, and 8), we will simulate the SSCE practical exam with a full mock project. This will test your skills, time management, and attention to detail from start to finish.

A. The project brief

- **Project:** A lined, sleeveless bodice (blouse).
- **Features:**
 - Front and back waist darts (shaping).
 - Bust darts.
 - A round neckline.
 - A 10-inch lapped zipper at the centre back.
 - "Bagged out" lining at the neckline and armholes.
- **Materials:** (As per a specimen list) 1m cotton fabric, 1m lining fabric, 10-inch zipper, matching thread.
- **Measurements:** You will use a standard size 10 measurement chart or your own.

B. Phase I: Interpretation and design

- **Task:** To understand and sketch the project.
- **Process:**
 1. Analyze the brief: Identify all required components (darts, zipper, lining).
 2. Create a "flat sketch" (a technical drawing) of the front and back of the bodice, clearly showing dart positions and the zipper.
 3. Confirm measurements (Bust, Waist, Nape-to-Waist).

C. Phase II: Pattern drafting

- **Task:** To create the paper patterns for the project.
- **Process:**
 1. **Draft the basic bodice block (front):** Using your measurements, draft the front bodice, including the centre-front line (on fold), neckline, shoulder, armhole, and waist.
 2. **Draft the basic bodice block (back):** Draft the back bodice, including the centre-back line (NOT on fold), neckline, shoulder, armhole, and waist.
 3. **Insert darts:** Plot and draw the bust darts and waist darts (front and back).
 4. **Draft the lining:** Trace the front and back blocks. The lining pattern is often slightly shorter than the main pattern.
 5. **Add allowances:** Add seam allowances (e.g., 1.5cm) to all edges. Add a 2cm allowance at the centre-back for the lapped zipper.

D. Phase III: Cutting

- **Task:** To lay out and cut the fabric accurately.
- **Process:**
 1. **Prepare fabric:** Press both the main fabric and the lining fabric to remove all wrinkles.
 2. **Lay out patterns:**
 - Fold the main fabric and place the front bodice pattern on the fold.
 - Place the back bodice pattern on the fabric, aligning the grainline.
 - Repeat for the lining fabric.
 3. **Pin and cut:** Pin the patterns securely and cut smoothly with shears.
 4. **Transfer markings:** This is critical. Use tailor's chalk or thread marks to transfer all dart lines and dots to the cut fabric pieces (both main and lining).

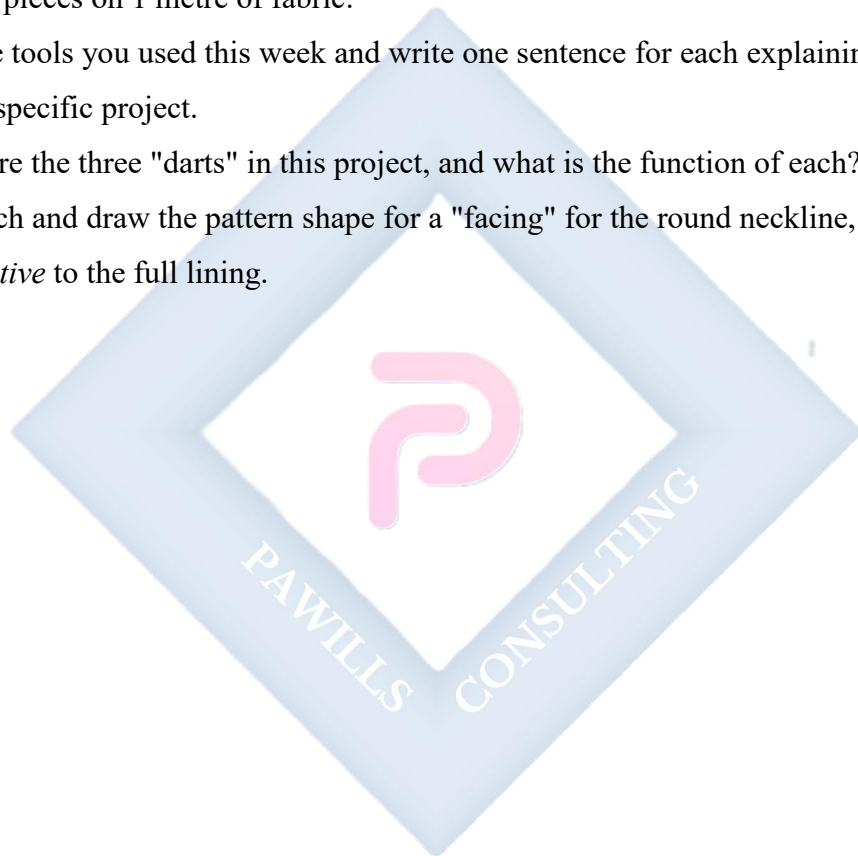
Evaluation questions

1. What is a "flat sketch"?
2. Why is the front bodice pattern piece usually placed on the "fold"?
3. Why is the back bodice pattern *not* placed on the fold for this project?

4. What does it mean to "transfer markings," and why is it important?
5. What is the purpose of the lining in this project?

Assignment questions

1. If you have not finished in class, complete the drafting and cutting of your bodice (main fabric and lining) for next week's class.
2. Create a "cutting plan" (a diagram) showing the most economical way to lay out your pattern pieces on 1 metre of fabric.
3. List the tools you used this week and write one sentence for each explaining its function in this specific project.
4. What are the three "darts" in this project, and what is the function of each?
5. Research and draw the pattern shape for a "facing" for the round neckline, as an *alternative* to the full lining.



WEEK 5: MIDTERM TEST

This week is dedicated to the midterm test. The test will be a combination of theory and practical assessment, covering:

- **Theory:** Questions on advanced construction (Week 1) and SSCE exam strategies (Weeks 2 & 3).
- **Practical:** A timed practical test, e.g., "Produce a sample of a lapped zipper" or "Draft and cut a pattern for a child's A-line dress."



WEEK 6: MOCK PROJECT II

TOPIC: SEWING & FINISHING

Introduction

We now continue with our mock project. All your pieces are cut, and the markings are transferred. This week is dedicated to the core construction and sewing, which carries the most marks in the exam.

A. Project recap

- **Project:** A lined, sleeveless bodice.
- **Status:** All pieces (main fabric and lining) are cut.
- **Goal:** To construct the main bodice, construct the lining, and attach them.

B. Phase IV: Construction (order of operations)

A systematic approach is crucial for a clean finish.

1. Stitch main fabric darts:

- Fold the fabric along the centre line of each dart, right sides together.
- Stitch from the wide end to the point.
- Do not backstitch at the point; instead, leave a thread tail and tie a knot. This prevents bunching.
- Stitch all four waist darts (2 front, 2 back) and the two bust darts.

2. Press main fabric darts:

- This is a critical, non-negotiable step.
- Press vertical waist darts *towards* the centre (CF and CB).
- Press horizontal bust darts *downwards*.

3. Stitch lining darts:

- Repeat steps 1 and 2 for all six darts on the lining pieces.

4. Join shoulder seams:

- Place the main fabric front and back pieces right-sides together.

- Pin and stitch the shoulder seams. Press seams open.
- Repeat for the lining pieces.

5. Join side seams:

- Place the main fabric front and back pieces right-sides together.
- Pin and stitch the side seams. Press seams open.
- Repeat for the lining pieces.

C. Phase V: Attaching the lining ("bagging out")

This is the "magic" step for a clean, professional finish.

- 1. Preparation:** You should now have two separate "bodices": one in main fabric and one in lining.
- 2. Attach:** Place the main bodice and the lining bodice *right sides together*.
- 3. Pin:** Carefully align and pin them at:
 - The entire neckline.
 - The right armhole.
 - The left armhole.
 - (The shoulder seams, side seams, and centre-back edges should match perfectly).
- 4. Stitch:**
 - Stitch around the entire neckline.
 - Stitch around the entire right armhole.
 - Stitch around the entire left armhole.
 - (Do NOT stitch the side seams or centre-back seams together).
- 5. Trim and clip:**
 - Trim the seam allowance by half.
 - Clip "V" notches into the curved edges of the neckline and armholes to release tension. Be careful not to cut your stitching.
- 6. Turn:**
 - Turn the entire garment right-side out by pulling it through one of the shoulder "tunnels."
- 7. Understitch:**

- Pull the lining away from the main fabric at the neckline and armholes.
- On the *lining* side, stitch the lining to the seam allowance (all layers). This will keep the lining from rolling out.

8. Press:

- Give the entire bodice a thorough press, focusing on the "turned" edges of the neckline and armholes.

Evaluation questions

1. Why is it better to tie a knot at the point of a dart instead of backstitching?
2. In which direction should vertical darts (like waist darts) be pressed?
3. What is the purpose of "clipping" curves?
4. Define "understitching" and its purpose.
5. What does it mean to "bag out" a lining?

Assignment questions

1. If you did not finish in class, complete all the sewing steps from this week's lesson. Your bodice should be a fully lined, turned, and pressed shell, with the centre-back and waist/hem open.
2. What is "grading" a seam? Why is it done, and how is it different from "clipping"?
3. Create a small sample of understitching on a curved scrap of fabric (e.g., a practice neckline).
4. Pressing is as important as sewing. Write a paragraph explaining the difference between "pressing" (up-and-down motion) and "ironing" (sliding motion) and why "pressing" is used in garment construction.
5. List three common mistakes that can happen during the "bagging out" process and how to avoid them.

WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

This week is for the midterm break. Students are advised to rest, but also to ensure their mock project is ready for the final phase of construction upon resumption.



WEEK 8: MOCK PROJECT III

TOPIC: FINAL FITTING & PRESENTATION

Introduction

This is the final stage of our mock project. This week, we will insert the zipper and finish the garment, paying close attention to the final pressing and presentation. These finishing touches are what elevate a garment from "homemade" to "professional."

A. Project recap

- **Project:** A lined, sleeveless bodice.
- **Status:** Bodice is "bagged out" at the neck and armholes. Centre-back and hem are open.
- **Goal:** To insert the lapped zipper and present a finished garment.

B. Phase VI: Zipper insertion (lapped zipper)

This is the most complex step of the project.

1. **Prepare the placket:** On the centre-back, fold and press the seam allowances (2cm) to the *inside* on both the main fabric and the lining.
2. **Create the underlap (Left side):**
 - Open the 10-inch zipper.
 - Place the *left* side of the bodice (as you would wear it) on the machine.
 - Stitch the *left* side of the zipper tape to the folded edge of the lining *only*.
3. **Create the overlap (Right side):**
 - Fold the right side of the bodice (main fabric and lining) along the pressed seam allowance, creating a 1.5cm overlap that covers the centre-back line.
 - Pin this folded edge over the zipper, completely covering the zipper teeth.
4. **Topstitch:**
 - Using a zipper foot, topstitch the overlap in place from the outside, about 1.2cm (1/2 inch) from the folded edge.

- Stitch down the length, pivot at the bottom, and stitch horizontally across the zipper base to secure it.
5. **Finish lining:** Hand-stitch the lining to the zipper tape on the inside for a clean finish.

C. Phase VII: Final finishing & presentation

This is the "20%" of the marking scheme that can make all the difference.

1. **Finishing the hem:** For this bodice, the main fabric and lining hems are typically finished separately (e.g., with a simple turned hem) or tucked into a skirt/trouser. For this project, we will "level" them (make sure they are even) and overlock or zigzag the raw edges together.
2. **Trimming threads:** Go over the *entire* garment (inside and out) with a small pair of scissors and trim every single loose thread.
3. **Final pressing:**
 - This is the most critical step.
 - Use a steam iron and a press cloth.
 - Press all seams flat.
 - Press the darts to their correct position.
 - Press the zipper placket flat.
 - Ensure there are no wrinkles.

D. Phase VIII: Peer/self-evaluation

- **Task:** Students will now grade their own project using a mock SSCE marking guide.
- **Checklist:**
 - **Interpretation:** Is it a lined, sleeveless bodice with all darts and a lapped zipper? (Yes/No)
 - **Construction:**
 - Are the darts sharp and pointing to the apex? (Rate /10)
 - Is the lining smooth, with no bubbling? (Rate /10)
 - Is the zipper insertion flat and neat, with a consistent overlap? (Rate /10)
 - **Finishing:**

- Is the garment pressed professionally? (Rate /10)
- Are all threads trimmed? (Yes/No)

Evaluation questions

1. What is a "lapped" zipper?
2. What is the "overlap" and "underlap" in a lapped zipper application?
3. Why is a zipper foot necessary for this task?
4. List three essential tasks in the "Final Finishing" phase.
5. Why is it important to "grade" your own work?

Assignment questions

1. Complete any unfinished steps on your bodice. Press it and mount it on a hanger for final submission.
2. Write a one-page "reflection" on your mock project. What was the easiest part? What was the most difficult part? What three things would you do differently to improve your grade in the real exam?
3. Research and describe the steps for inserting an *invisible* zipper, and explain how this is different from the lapped zipper we did in class.
4. Draw a diagram showing the topstitching path for a lapped zipper.
5. Create a "Final Finishing Kit" to keep with your sewing tools. What 5 items would you include? (e.g., small scissors, lint roller, press cloth, etc.)

WEEK 9: MOCK SSCE

TOPIC: INTERNAL EXAMS

Introduction

This week is dedicated to a full-scale simulation of the SSCE Fashion Design & Garment Making examination. This internal exam will mirror the structure, content, and timing of the external exam to give you the most realistic practice possible.

- **Paper 1: Objective (1 hour)**
 - 50 multiple-choice questions covering the SS1-SS3 syllabus, with a focus on fibres, tools, safety, design, and business.
- **Paper 2: Theory (2 hours)**
 - Essay-style questions. You will be required to answer 4 or 5 questions, likely from different sections, testing your knowledge of construction processes, business, and design principles.
- **Paper 3: Practical (3 hours)**
 - A *new* practical test will be administered.
 - **Example Brief:** "Using the materials and measurements provided, draft, cut, and sew a pair of shorts.
 - **Features:** A centre-front fly zipper, side pockets, and a waistband."
 - (This tests a different, complex skill set from the bodice project).

Evaluation

- This week is purely for examination. Evaluation will be based on your performance in the three papers.

Assignment

- Rest and prepare for your Mock SSCE. Ensure your practical exam kit is fully stocked.

WEEK 10: EXAM PREP & COACHING

TOPIC: MOCK REVIEW & FINAL STRATEGIES

Introduction

The mock exam is over. This week, we will review your performance, analyze common mistakes, and finalize your mental and practical strategies for the real SSCE. This is your final coaching session.

A. Review of mock exam

- **Paper 1 (Objectives):** We will go over the most-missed questions. Common problem areas are often fibre properties and business calculations.
- **Paper 2 (Theory):** We will review high-scoring answers vs. low-scoring answers.
 - *Common Mistake:* Not writing enough detail for "Describe" or "Explain" questions.
 - *Common Mistake:* Misunderstanding the question.
- **Paper 3 (Practical):** We will display and critique several of the finished mock projects (anonymously).
 - *Common Mistake:* Poor time management (e.g., unfinished hems).
 - *Common Mistake:* Messy finishing (e.g., loose threads, poor pressing).
 - *Common Mistake:* Inaccurate zipper or pocket insertion.

B. Time management clinic

- **Theory:** Allocate your time *per question*. If you have 2 hours for 4 questions, that is 30 minutes per question. Stick to it.
- **Practical:** Re-emphasize the 3-hour plan (Week 3). If you get stuck on one part (e.g., the zipper), *move on* to another part (e.g., the hem) and come back. An unfinished zipper but a finished hem is better than both being unfinished.
- **Objectives:** Answer what you know first. Go back for the ones you are unsure about. Do not leave any answer blank.

C. The essential practical exam kit

Let's do a final check of the kit you will take into the exam hall.

- **Cutting:** Shears (fabric), Scissors (paper), Seam ripper, Pinking shears (optional).
- **Measuring:** Tape measure, Seam gauge, Rulers (straight, L-square, French curve).
- **Marking:** Tailor's chalk, pencils, eraser.
- **Sewing:** Pins (in a cushion), hand needles, thimble.
- **Supplies:** Correct fabric/specimens, matching threads (always bring extra), bobbins, buttons, zippers (as per list).
- **Other:** Calculator (for business paper), pen, pencil.

D. Dealing with exam anxiety

- It is normal to be nervous. This means you care.
- **Strategy:** Read the *entire* question paper before you start. Take 3 deep breaths.
- **Practical:** If you make a mistake (e.g., stitch a seam wrong), *do not panic*. Calmly use your seam ripper, unpick it, press the fabric, and do it again. A neat correction is better than a messy panic.
- **Confidence:** You have been practicing for three years. You have all the skills. Trust your training.

Evaluation questions

1. What was the most common mistake in our class's mock practical exam?
2. What is a good strategy for managing time in the theory paper?
3. Why should you "move on" if you get stuck on one part of the practical?
4. List 5 "must-have" items in your practical exam kit.
5. What is the first thing you should do when you receive your exam paper?

Assignment questions

1. Based on your mock results, identify your *one* weakest area (e.g., "welt pockets," "theory of fibres," "costing").

2. Write a one-page "Study Sheet" for that *one* weak area.
3. Create one final, perfect sample of your weakest practical skill (e.g., a bound buttonhole, a fly zipper).
4. Go through 50 objective past questions. Time yourself. How long did it take?
5. Write down your personal "Time Plan" for the 3-hour practical exam and stick it to the inside of your sewing kit.



WEEK 11-13: REVISION & EXAMS

- **WEEK 11:** Final revision of all SS1, SS2, and SS3 work. Focus on practical drills and reviewing theory past questions.
- **WEEK 12:** External Examinations (SSCE) begin.
- **WEEK 13:** External Examinations (SSCE) continue.

